- Use `DB::raw()` for custom column calculations.
- Filter and sort data with `whereRaw()` and `orderByRaw()`.
- Safely bind input parameters to avoid SQL injection.
- Display query results using a Bootstrap-based view.

11.8.3 Prerequisites

- Laravel 12 installed
- MySQL or compatible database
- PHP 8.2+
- Composer
- Code editor (e.g., VS Code)

> *This lab uses **PHP 8.4**, **Laravel 12** and **Visual Studio Code** as the primary editor.*

11.8.4 Steps

Here are the steps to create a simple report application using Laravel 12 Query Builder with raw expressions.

11.8.4.1 Step 1: Create a New Laravel Project

We will create a new Laravel project using the following command:

```
laravel new laravel12-querybuilder-raw
cd laravel12-querybuilder-raw
code .
```

Aceept the default options for the installation including the database connection. We use SQLLite for this lab, but you can adapt the code for MySQL or any other supported database.

You should see the Laravel project structure in your code editor.

11.8.4.2 Step 2: Configure `.env` with Database Connection

Since we are using default SQLite database, you can skip this step. If you want to use MySQL, you can configure the `.env` file with your database connection.